

Psalms 77

I Will Remember

I will remember the works of the Lord
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *I cried unto God with my voice, even unto God with my voice; and he gave ear unto me.*
- 2 *In the day of my trouble I sought the Lord: my sore ran in the night, and ceased not: my soul refused to be comforted.*
- 3 *I remembered God, and was troubled: I complained, and my spirit was overwhelmed. Selah.*
- 4 *Thou holdest mine eyes waking: I am so troubled that I cannot speak.*
- 5 *I have considered the days of old, the years of ancient times.*
- 6 *I call to remembrance my song in the night: I commune with mine own heart: and my spirit made diligent search.*
- 7 *Will the Lord cast off for ever? and will he be favourable no more?*
- 8 *Is his mercy clean gone for ever? doth his promise fail for evermore?*
- 9 *Hath God forgotten to be gracious? hath he in anger shut up his tender mercies? Selah.*
- 10 *And I said, This is my infirmity: but I will remember the years of the right hand of the most High.*
- 11 *I will remember the works of the LORD: surely I will remember thy wonders of old.*
- 12 *I will meditate also of all thy work, and talk of thy doings.*
- 13 *Thy way, O God, is in the sanctuary: who is so great a God as our God?*
- 14 *Thou art the God that doest wonders: thou hast declared thy strength among the people.*
- 15 *Thou hast with thine arm redeemed thy people, the sons of Jacob and Joseph. Selah.*
- 16 *The waters saw thee, O God, the waters saw thee; they were afraid: the depths also were troubled.*
- 17 *The clouds poured out water: the skies sent out a sound: thine arrows also went abroad.*
- 18 *The voice of thy thunder was in the heaven: the lightnings lightened the world: the earth trembled and shook.*
- 19 *Thy way is in the sea, and thy path in the great waters, and thy footsteps are not known.*
- 20 *Thou leddest thy people like a flock by the hand of Moses and Aaron.*

2 · CONTEXT

Asaph moves through a night of insomnia and spiritual despair into deliberate, disciplined remembrance. The psalm's structure is instructive: raw complaint and hard questions about God's character give way not to a resolved feeling but to a decision—to remember, to meditate, to search out God's works of old, climaxing in the exodus through the sea. Henry treats this as a model for handling the feeling that God has changed or withdrawn.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

The psalmist cries out to God in trouble, seeking Him with his whole strength, yet finds no comfort—remembering God only troubles him further, and his spirit is overwhelmed. Even the act of thinking about God, in this state, brings no relief.

Verse 4-6

Sleeplessness compounds the distress; he is too troubled even to speak. He deliberately considers days of old, remembers songs sung in the night, communes with his own heart, and makes a diligent search—active mental and spiritual effort, not passive waiting.

Verse 7-9

The search produces hard questions stated plainly: will the Lord cast off forever, is His mercy completely gone, has He forgotten to be gracious, has anger shut up His tender mercies for good? These are not rhetorical—they are the honest fears driving the whole psalm.

Verse 10-12

A decisive turn: he names his despair as 'my infirmity'—an admission that his perception, not necessarily reality, may be the problem. He resolves to remember the years of God's right hand, to remember and meditate specifically on God's works and doings, deliberately redirecting his focus.

Verse 13-15

Meditation produces a fresh confession: God's way is holy, no god compares to Him, He is the God who does wonders. He has already declared His strength among the peoples and redeemed His covenant people—Jacob and Joseph named specifically as evidence, not abstraction.

Verse 16-20

The psalm climaxes in vivid poetic recollection of the exodus: waters that saw God and trembled, clouds pouring rain, thunder rolling, the earth shaking, a path made through the sea whose footprints were never traced, and a flock led safely by the hand of Moses and Aaron. Remembering this specific, historical act of deliverance is where the psalm—somewhat abruptly—ends, its own answer to the opening despair.

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Despair that questions whether God has permanently changed His character toward mercy is common even among faithful believers, and Scripture does not silence the question. The resolution the psalm models is not new information or a resolved feeling, but a deliberate discipline of remembering and meditating on God's proven works, allowing the facts of what He has done to outweigh the feelings of the present moment.

Application for life today.

When despair tells you God has withdrawn His mercy, follow Asaph's pattern: name the fear honestly, then deliberately turn to remember specific, concrete things God has done—in Scripture and in your own history. Notice that the psalm doesn't end with resolved emotion, only with a fixed gaze on God's past faithfulness; give yourself permission to keep meditating even before your feelings catch up. Consider keeping a written record of God's works in your life to draw on during your own sleepless nights.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Which of the hard questions in verses 7–9 have you privately asked, and how does this psalm validate bringing them to God directly?

2. What specific 'works of the Lord' from your own history could you deliberately remember and meditate on this week, following verses 11–12?

3. Why might the psalm end on remembered history rather than a resolved feeling—and how does that shape what you expect from your own prayer?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).